
IPAK-EDU INSTITUTIONAL REVIEW BOARD (IRB)

Proposal Templates

(Last updated March 15, 2024)

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Part A. IPAKIRB Form 1: Intake Form

Title of Study:

Multisite Parent-Reported Data Resource of Sudden-Onset Regressive Autism (SORA)

Principal Investigator (PI) Name: Brian Hooker, Ph.D.

Affiliation: Children's Health Defense (CHD) [confirm exact legal entity, PI title, and affiliation]

Address: TBD - coordinating PI/sponsor mailing address

Contact Information

E-mail: TBD - coordinating PI email

Phone: TBD - coordinating PI telephone

Budget and Funding Source:

Funder: TBD. Proposed clinic compensation: flat \$5,000 per activated clinic, up to 10 clinics; total study budget TBD.

Human or Animal Study:

Human - minimal-risk survey/data-resource study with limited record validation

Description of the Study:

This minimal-risk, multisite data-resource study will use a clinic-distributed electronic survey to collect structured parent reports of sudden-onset regressive autism (SORA): an abrupt, dramatic, persistent developmental or behavioral change with a distinguishable Day 0, followed by a clinical ASD diagnosis. The study addresses a measurement gap because existing research has not been identified that combines a narrowly defined discrete onset, individual-day vaccination proximity, recall-quality measures, and random documentary validation. Clinics will invite their complete defined contactable populations but will not disclose patient lists to CHD. The goal is to create, quality-check, document, and release a coded, disclosure-reviewed dataset for independent analysis. This collection study will not test causation or estimate population incidence.

Specific Aims:

Type: minimal-risk, multisite, clinic-distributed, parent-completed coded electronic survey with an embedded record-validation substudy. Aim 1: collect standardized information on developmental pattern, parent-recognized SORA Day 0, onset age, the three qualifying change categories, and elapsed vaccination proximity. Aim 2: document recruitment flow, missingness, recall horizon, confidence, timing anchors, information sources, prior causal attribution, and post-onset vaccination decisions. Aim 3: assess agreement for a randomly selected, separately authorized subset using limited contemporaneous onset evidence and vaccination records. Aim 4: produce a documented, disclosure-reviewed public-use dataset, or aggregate and controlled-

access data if row-level release is not safe, together with descriptive data-quality and feasibility reporting.

Estimated Duration of Study:

Proposed start: TBD, only after IRB approval and completion of all operational gates. Proposed end: 12 months after study initiation [confirm]. Clinic enrollment is initially 30 days and may extend through Day 90 until the fourth clinic activates; each clinic's invitation campaign lasts 35 days, followed by the prespecified survey and validation lock periods.

Participant Population:

Adult respondents (age 18 or older) who are parents or legal guardians in participating autism diagnosis/treatment clinics' complete defined contactable populations, including families of children evaluated but not diagnosed with ASD. All consenting respondents may provide screening/background data. The SORA analytic resource is limited to reports about a child with a subsequent clinical ASD diagnosis, parent-recognized onset before the fifth birthday, a discrete rather than gradual Day 0, at least one qualifying category beginning on Day 0 (new pathological behavior, loss of an existing behavior/skill, or changed sensory sensitivity), and persistence for at least 30 days or through a later clinical evaluation. Children are not contacted and undergo no intervention. A random eligible subset may enter validation only after separate authorization. Final inclusion/exclusion and Subpart D findings are subject to IRB approval.

► **Instructions For Submission**

Please submit this completed intake form to irbmanager@ipakirb.com.

Upon review, we will schedule a 15-minute consultation call to discuss the feasibility of your study design and provide initial feedback before you proceed with the full proposal.
